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KIHWAN YU

CONTACT INFORMATION

Office Waters 331H, 1603 Old Claflin Pl
Manhattan, KS 66506, USA

Email kihwanyu@ksu.edu
Website https://kihwan-yu.github.io

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Agricultural and Agri-Environmental Policy, Production Economics, Risk Management, and International Trade

EDUCATION

Kansas State University — Manhattan, KS
Ph.D. in Agricultural Economics — Expected May 2027

Seoul National University — Seoul, South Korea
M.A. in Agricultural and Resource Economics — 2019

Kangwon National University — Chuncheon, South Korea
B.A. in Agricultural and Resource Economics and Psychology — 2017

JOB MARKET PAPER

"The Supply of Offers and Bids in the Conservation Reserve Program"
Kihwan Yu, Nathan P. Hendricks and Nazli Z. Uludere Aragon

Abstract: A central challenge in payments for ecosystem services (PES) is designing mechanisms that procure environmental benefits cost-effectively. While many PES programs use auction mechanisms with reference prices to reduce information rents, existing evidence provides limited guidance on how reference prices affect potential sellers' bidding behavior. Identifying the effect of reference prices is challenging because of their mechanical link to the opportunity cost of enrollment. This paper addresses this problem by exploiting two sources of plausibly exogenous variation generated by the CRP auction rules and integrating field-level geospatial CRP offer records with large-scale satellite-derived land cover data. We find that higher reference prices are largely captured by landowners through higher rental bids, with limited evidence that they induce substantially more acres offered.

PUBLICATIONS

"Resource-Driven Agricultural Clusters: Coagglomeration Effects of the High Plains Aquifer"
American Journal of Agricultural Economics, 2026. Published online. https://doi.org/10.1002/ajae.70105
Kihwan Yu and Nathan P. Hendricks

Abstract: Quantifying the regional economic impacts of crop production is critical for assessing the broader implications of access to natural resources and government policies. However, most existing estimates rely on input-output models with restrictive assumptions and competing theories of economic mechanisms provide little guidance on the sign or magnitude. We estimate local economic spillovers by exploiting a large increase in crop production that occurred due to the expansion of irrigation in counties overlying the High Plains Aquifer after World War II. While crop production was directly impacted by access to groundwater, we find that livestock product sales also increased significantly, reaching a 235% increase in sales compared to counties outside the aquifer. The primary spillover to non-farm sectors was an increase in sales in the wholesale sector, perhaps driven by sales of agricultural-related products. These findings provide evidence of coagglomeration incentives, where clusters of agricultural industries find it optimal to produce within the same region.

Kim, Y. J., Jung, J., Yu, K., Kim, S., and Olynk Widmar, N. 2024. **"**Spatial differentiation in food service pricing: an explorative study with web-scraped data.**"** *International Food and Agribusiness Management Review*, 27(3), 566–592.

(Journal Articles in Korean)

Yu, K., Jeong, D., and Kim, K. 2021. "Estimating the Effects of Donation Tax Reduction on Farmland Using a Generalized Propensity Approach." *The Korean Journal of Agricultural Economics*, 62(1), 1–21.

Yu, K., and Kim, K. 2019. "An Estimation of Welfare Effects of Minimum Wage Increase in an Agricultural Production Sector Using a Stochastic Equilibrium Displacement Model." *The Korean Journal of Agricultural Economics*, 60(2), 1–21.

WORK IN PROGRESS

"Risk Aggregation, Insurance Demand, and Production Decision: An Analysis of Enterprise Unit Discounts"
Kihwan Yu and Nathan P. Hendricks

AWARDS

Outstanding Article Award, Korean Agricultural Economics Association 2022
Outstanding Undergraduate Thesis Award, Kangwon National University 2016

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record, Kansas State University
AGEC 115, Decision Tools for Agricultural Economics and Agribusiness Fall 2024
Overall Teaching Effectiveness: 4.6/5.0

Workshop Instructor, Kansas State University
Introductory R Workshop for Incoming Students 2025, 2026

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant, Kansas State University 2023–Present
Researcher, Korea Rural Economic Institute 2020–2022
- Developed web-scraping workflows for online retail data and workflows for offline retail scanner data

Researcher, Seoul National University 2019
- Evaluated the effects of tax incentives on production decisions and welfare

Graduate Research Assistant, Seoul National University 2017–2018

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Presenter. "The supply of offers and bids in the Conservation Reserve Program." Heartland Environmental and Resource Economics Workshop, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Urbana-Champaign, IL, 2026.
Presenter. "The supply of offers and bids in the Conservation Reserve Program." Annual Meeting of the Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA), Kansas City, MO, 2026.
Presenter. "Local Economic Spillovers of Irrigation from the High Plains Aquifer to the Agricultural and Non-Agricultural Sectors." Annual Meeting of the Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA), New Orleans, LA, 2024.
Coauthor. "Spatial Differentiation in Pricing Strategy of Restaurant Business: An Explorative Study with Network Analysis Based on Web-Scraped Data from a Delivery Application." Annual Meeting of the Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA), Washington, DC, 2023.

Presenter. "Identifying the Impact of Emergency Disaster Relief Fund in Agri-Food Industry during the COVID-19 Pandemic in Korea: A Synthetic Control and Stochastic Equilibrium Displacement Method Approach." Annual Meeting of the Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA), Virtual, 2021.
Presenter. "Estimating the Effects of HMR Consumption Increase on Food Industry in Korea: A Stochastic Multi-sector and Multi-market Equilibrium Displacement Modelling Approach." Annual Meeting of the Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA), Virtual, 2020.
Presenter. "An Economic Evaluation of Climate Effects on Urban Flood Damages: The Case of Seoul, South Korea." Annual Meeting of the North American Regional Science Council (NARSC), Pittsburgh, PA, 2019.

SERVICE & LEADERSHIP

Peer Academic Advisor for Undergraduate Students	2016
President, Food System Research Society	2015
Student Social Committee Member, Agricultural Economics	2014

REFERENCES

Nathan Hendricks	Professor nph@ksu.edu Kansas State University	**Jesse Tack**	Professor jtack@ksu.edu Kansas State University
Jennifer Ifft	Professor jifft@ksu.edu Kansas State University	**Jisang Yu**	Associate Professor jisangyu@korea.ac.kr Korea University